

Kitchen Roots

by KruehCooks | Zip Code Wilmington Passion Project

What It Is

Kitchen Roots is a digital family recipe book preserving Liberian fusion dishes and other dishes I've refined over the years while cooking for my family, alongside dishes I've expanded on and refined through Krueh Cooks. Every recipe is documented as a piece of lineage, capturing origin, region, and family stories alongside the ingredients and steps.

Why It Matters

My family is from Liberia, West Africa. Liberia's food traditions share a documented historical connection with the Gullah Geechee culinary tradition of the American South. That connection traces back to the transatlantic slave trade and shared West African agricultural roots: rice cultivation, okra, palm oil, and one-pot stews. Kitchen Roots is built to surface those food lineage connections, not just store recipes.

MVP Scope

- Structured recipe entries: ingredients, steps, origin/region, tags
- Searchable and browsable recipe list
- A sample wiki-style page per recipe, showing the full structure in action
- Recipes linkable to a Region / Heritage Note (e.g. rice cultivation, West Africa to Lowcountry)

Future Phases

- Premium / paywall tier for expanded content (data model supports this from day one, even though it's out of scope now)
- Possible genealogy integration (e.g. Ancestry.com API) to trace a dish through family migration history

Tech Stack

Three-tier application per program requirements: JavaScript frontend (UI), Flask (Python) middle-tier server, and a SQLite3 database. Recipe data is modeled relationally; a recipe's full record can also be served as JSON for the wiki page or a future API.